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4.1 INTRODUCTION

4.1.1 This chapter has been prepared by David Lock Associates, to report its socio-economic assessment of the likely significant effects of the Proposed Development during the construction stage and following completion.

4.1.2 This chapter assesses the current social and economic conditions in the South Marston and Rowborough area, as well as the wider area of Swindon Borough and examines the potential effects of the Proposed Development on population, housing, employment, education, health, community facilities, open space, public safety and retail. The direct and indirect effects of the Proposed Development and their significance are assessed.

4.2 ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

Scope and Area of Study

4.2.1 The Application Site lies in the Borough of Swindon, within the St Margaret and South Marston Ward. This is a relatively new ward, established in November 2011 to accommodate the electoral and administrative needs of the planned population growth to the east of Swindon. The St Margaret and South Marston Ward encompasses South Marston village including the proposed expansion at South Marston, Rowborough and extending south of the A420 into the northern edge of the proposed New Eastern Villages (NEV). The ward also includes the urban parish of Stratton St Margaret, west of the A419, within the urban area of Swindon.

4.2.2 Prior to this administrative boundary review, the Application Site lay within the Blunsdon Ward, a more rural ward, distinct from the urban area of Swindon, encompassing the villages of South Marston and Broad Blunsdon. Therefore, to establish the baseline socio-economic conditions of the Application Site, data from the Blunsdon Ward has been referenced, particularly from the most recent Census (March 2011), when the relevant Site data would have been captured under the Blunsdon Ward. This approach ensures a robust examination of the likely socio-economic effects of the Proposed Development.

4.2.3 It should be noted that the Proposed Development will have effects on the wider area of Swindon and as a result the Study Area is Swindon as a whole.

Data sources

4.2.4 This assessment draws upon published Government and local authority statistics, and economic strategy documents relating to the area, including the 2011 Census, other ONS data and documents published by Swindon Borough Council (SBC) and other organisations such as the NHS. SBC has produced specific contextual information for the Proposed Development; the emerging draft versions of the *New Eastern Villages SPD* and *South Marston SPD* are of particular relevance.

4.2.5 The assessment also draws upon supporting studies that are submitted in support of the Outline Planning Application (OPA) such as Green Infrastructure Strategy.

4.2.6 In addition to desktop baseline work, visits to the Site and the wider area were undertaken to collect and verify information on local facilities. Advice was also sought from SBC.

4.2.7 The following prevailing socio-economic conditions in Swindon Borough including the immediate context of the Site have been considered in identifying the likely significant effects of the Proposed Development:

- demographic profile;
- economic activity, including unemployment, business activity around the Site, skills and occupational structure;
- housing stock, affordability and quality;
- living environment and aggregate deprivation;
- school capacity; and
- heathcare capacity;

4.2.8 The assessment takes into account predicted population within the Proposed Development and its likely demographic profile.

Assessment approach

4.2.9 Following an understanding of the baseline conditions, the assessment examines the potential significant effects that the Proposed Development would be likely to have in terms of:

- changes in population numbers and housing;
- changes in employment provision and commuting patterns;
- number of construction related jobs generated through the phased construction programme;
- the impacts associated with increased demand on social infrastructure, including:
  - education;
  - health;

- public open space for formal and informal recreation;
- community facilities;
- retail provision; and
- accessibility and public safety.

4.2.10 Opportunities to mitigate any potential adverse effects are then identified as well as any residual effects that might remain following mitigation.

4.2.11 With regard to the manner in which the duration of impact is described, temporary impacts (short to medium term) are considered to be those associated with the construction stage and permanent impacts (long term) are those associated with the completed Proposed Development.

Assessment Criteria

4.2.12 There are no generally accepted criteria for assessing the significance of socio-economic effects and, in some cases, it can be difficult to quantify or measure such effects. The assessment of significance of impacts is based on the magnitude of the predicted change to the baseline position, as well as the sensitivity of the socio-economic "receptors". Where the effect has been difficult to quantify, qualitative professional judgment has been applied, based on experience. Impacts are identified as either beneficial or adverse, whilst their significance is classified as either "major", "moderate", "minor" or "negligible".

4.2.13 Magnitudes of change are rated as Large, Moderate, Small or Negligible and can be Direct or Indirect, and Beneficial or Adverse. Examples of changes of each of these levels of magnitude are set out in Table 4.1.

Table 4.1: Examples of socio-economic changes of different magnitude

Magnitude	Direct Effects	Indirect Effects
Large Beneficial	Substantial increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	Substantial increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.
Moderate Beneficial	Moderate increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	Moderate increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.
Small Beneficial	Minor increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	Minor increase in jobs, homes, retail, green space and improvements to other socio-economic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.
Negligible	No appreciable effect on net employment on site, retail provision, housing provision or other socio-economic indicators as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	No appreciable effect on net employment off site, retail provision, housing provision or other socio-economic indicators indirectly related to the Proposed Development.
Small Adverse	Minor loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space and deterioration of other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	Minor loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space and deterioration to other socioeconomic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.
Moderate Adverse	Moderate loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space and deterioration of other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	Moderate loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space and deterioration to other socio-economic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.
Large Adverse	Substantial loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space	Substantial loss of jobs, homes, retail, green space

	and deterioration of other socio-economic indicators etc as a direct consequence of the Proposed Development.	and deterioration to other socio-economic indicators etc as an indirect consequence of but not only related to the Proposed Development.

4.2.14 The Proposed Development will affect the Site and its surroundings to varying degrees, depending on the sensitivity of the receptor. The sensitivity of local receptors to the effects of the Proposed Development is classified as high, medium, low or negligible as set out in Table 4.2 below.

4.2.15 Using an example is an appropriate way to demonstrate the relative sensitivities of different socio-economic receptors. The Proposed Development will create a range of employment opportunities. Those opportunities associated with the construction stage will be temporary and therefore considered low in sensitivity; however, some employment will also be required to serve some of the elements of the Proposed Development, such as the local centres. Those jobs will be permanent and will deliver a lasting impact on socio-economic conditions and should therefore be considered as being of high sensitivity.

Table 4.2: Sensitivity of socio-economic receptors

Receptor	Nature of Effect	Sensitivity
Construction		
Population, Housing, Education and Health	Temporary	Negligible
Employment	Temporary	Low
Completed Development		
Population & Housing	Permanent	High
Employment	Permanent	High
Education	Permanent	Medium
Health	Permanent	Medium
Community Facilities	Permanent	Medium
Open Space	Permanent	Medium
Crime	Permanent	Low
Retail	Permanent	Medium

4.2.16 The significance of the socio-economic effects of the Proposed Development is determined by the interaction between the magnitude of the change and the sensitivity of the receptor concerned. Table 4.3 comprises a matrix that demonstrates how the significance of effects has been determined.

Table 4.3: Significance of socio-economic effects

MAGNITUDE of Change	**SENSITIVITY of receptor to Change**			
	High	**Medium**	**Low**	**Negligible**
Large	Major	Major	Moderate	Minor
Moderate	Major	Moderate	Minor	Negligible
Small	Moderate	Minor	Minor	Negligible
Negligible	Minor	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible

4.3 RELEVANT POLICY

4.3.1 This section identifies planning policies at national and local level that are particularly relevant to the socio-economic effects of the Proposed Development. Policies of broader relevance to the Proposed Development are introduced in **Chapter 3** of this ES.

National Planning Policy Framework (March 2012)

4.3.2 The *National Planning Policy Framework* (NPPF) sets out a "presumption in favour of sustainable development" (paragraph 14) and seeks to promote "sustainable economic growth through the planning system" (paragraph 19).

4.3.3 At paragraph 17, the NPPF sets out a series of core planning principles that should underpin both plan- making and decision-taking; these state that planning should:

- find ways to enhance and improve the places in which people live their lives;
- proactively drive and support sustainable economic development to deliver homes and business and industrial units, infrastructure and thriving local places;
- seek to secure high quality design and a good standard of amenity;
- promote the vitality of the main urban areas, protect Green Belts, recognise the intrinsic character and beauty of the countryside and support thriving communities within it;
- encourage the effective use of land;
- promote mixed use developments, and encourage multiple benefits from the use of land in urban and rural areas, recognising some land can perform many functions (such as wildlife, recreation, flood risk mitigation, carbon storage, or food production); and
- support local strategies to improve health, social and cultural wellbeing and deliver sufficient community and cultural facilities to meet local needs.

4.3.4 Paragraph 69 of the NPPF acknowledges the role of the planning system in facilitating healthy and inclusive communities and safe and accessible developments which contain clear and legible pedestrian routes and high quality public open space.

4.3.5 Paragraph 70 of the NPPF seeks the promotion of social, recreational and cultural facilities and services, such as high quality open space and community facilities such as local shops, meeting places, sports venues and places of worship.

The Development Plan

4.3.6 Following the revocation of RPG10 on 20 May 2013 and with it the Wilshire and Swindon Structure Plan 2016, the statutory development plan for Swindon Borough comprises solely the saved policies of the *Swindon Borough Local Plan 2011* (2006).

Swindon Borough Local Plan 2011

4.3.7 The *Swindon Borough Local Plan 2011* was adopted in 2006. A number of its policies have been 'saved' by direction of the Secretary of State and remain relevant until such time that the *Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026* is adopted.

4.3.8 Policy ENV8 requires appropriate provision to allow ease of access for everybody including facilities for disabled people.

4.3.9 Policy H5 requires new residential development to provide safe and convenient access to basic local services and facilities.

4.3.10 Policy R1 requires recreation, sport and leisure facilities to be accessible by a choice of means of transport, including public transport, walking and cycling. Policy R4 seeks the protection of recreational open space.

4.3.11 Policy CF1 requires new local health services and CF2 requires premises for community, ethnic and religious needs respectively to be well located in relation to their intended catchment areas.

Emerging Local Policy

***Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026: Submission Document* (2013)**

4.3.12 The emerging Local Plan will set out the planning policy framework to deliver growth within the Borough up until 2026. SBC submitted a draft version of the Local Plan to the Secretary of State on 28 June 2013.

4.3.13 Policy NC3 allocates the Site as part of a mixed use urban extension of about 8,000 new homes with associated retail, employment, education and leisure uses to the east of Swindon.

4.3.14 The Site comprises the allocated land north of the A420, which includes the allocation at Rowborough and the expansion of South Marston.

4.3.15 The policy requirements for the New Eastern Villages as a whole include:

- provision of a high quality public realm including outdoor civic public space;
- sustainable transport links;
- green infrastructure that maximises opportunities for habitat connectivity and enhanced biodiversity;
- sports and leisure facilities;
- employment land (B use classes) that complements a mixed use District Centre;
- retail and complementary uses to be distributed across the District Centre and a network of Local Centres and within the expanded South Marston;
- a minimum of 8 forms of entry of secondary and primary provision with early learning facilities, a site for a special school;
- community facilities;
- health care facility with GP, dentist and pharmacy at the District Centre; and
- safeguarded land for a fire station.

4.3.16 Policy RA3 seeks to ensure the expansion of South Marston contributes towards the creation of an integrated village with a distinct rural and separate identity from Swindon and other settlements. The policy requires development at South Marston to provide:

- housing at an average density of 30 dwellings per hectare and affordable housing at no more than 20%;
- community and recreation facilities and retail provision of an appropriate scale, as part of the village centre;
- green infrastructure;
- an extended recreation ground; and
- an extension to the primary school.

4.3.17 There are also emerging SPDs that are relevant to the socio-economic impacts of the Proposed Development, which include *Eastern Villages Draft Supplementary Planning Document* SPD and Draft South Marston SPD.

Eastern Villages Draft Supplementary Planning Document

4.3.18 The draft Eastern Villages SPD provides guidance for and direction to the delivery of development in the New Eastern Villages, in accordance with Policy NC3 of the submitted Local Plan. It sets the framework for delivery of economic growth through a mixed use development and guides the timely implementation of required infrastructure and transport objectives.

South Marston Draft Supplementary Planning Document

4.3.19 The draft South Marston SPD provides a detailed planning framework setting out the requirements for development at South Marston, including addressing existing traffic, land use and community issues. It has been prepared in partnership with South Marston Parish Council.

4.3.20 The draft South Marston SPD places a requirement for community owned space in the centre of the village, to serve both the expanded school and to accommodate community hall and village facilities.

4.4 BASELINE CONDITIONS

4.4.1 This section describes current socio-economic conditions within the Study Area.

General Geographic Context

4.4.2 The application boundary is shown in **Appendix 1.1**. As set out in Chapter 2 of the ES, the Application Site lies to the north east of the built up area of Swindon and comprises approximately 162 Ha of agricultural land. The A420 runs alongside the Great Western mainline railway, which together form the southern boundary of the Site. The A419 runs beyond the western boundary of the Site, beyond which lies the urban area of Swindon. The A419 is a trunk route giving access from the M4 around the east of Swindon and north to Cirencester and to the M5 near Cheltenham and Gloucester. To the immediate north of the Site lies the village of South Marston, while the Site extends east to incorporate Rowborough Farm.

Population

4.4.3 Swindon is home to 3.8% of the total population of the South West and has the 6th highest population density of the 16 unitary and district authorities that comprise the South West region[1].

4.4.4 Swindon Urban Area is approximately 230 km^2 (23,000 ha) and has a population of around 209,156 with approximately 66.4 % of residents of working age (between 16-64 years of age)[2]. In 2011, based on data provided by ONS, only 0.038% more males than females lived in Swindon. Again, using the 2011 ONS data, the Borough currently has a large proportion of people in the 30-44 and the 45-59 age groups. [3]

4.4.5 Swindon's population is predominantly urban with around 85% of all households living in the town.[4]

4.4.6 The proportion of Swindon's population from black and minority ethnic groups is 10.2%, lower than the average for England at 15.6[5].

[1] South West Observatory Local Profiles, Swindon
[2] Census 2011: Usual Resident Population, local authorities in England and Wales, published by ONS
[3] Census 2011: Age Structure, local authorities in England and Wales, published by ONS
[4] Swindon Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2012

4.4.7 At the time of the 2011 Census, the Application Site lay within the Blunsdon Ward. The 2011 Census reports a ward population of 3,360, split 49% male to 51 % female and 64.1 % of working age.[6]

Table 4.4: Population Age Structure

	Blunsdon Ward	Swindon	South West	England
Persons aged 0-4	4.7%	6.7%	5.6%	6.3%
Persons aged 5-14	10.8%	11.8%	10.7%	11.4%
Persons aged 15-19	6.3%	5.9%	6.2%	6.3%
Persons aged 20-44	23.5%	36.5%	30.9%	34.3%
Persons aged 45-64	34.4%	25.3%	26.9%	25.4%
Persons aged 65+	20.3%	13.8%	19.6%	16.4%

Source: ONS, 2011 (Census: Usual resident population by five year age group, wards in England and Wales).

4.4.8 The population forecasts for Swindon Borough predict a stable population growth over the next 10 years. Projections indicate a continuing rise in population with 239,500 forecast to be living in the Borough by 2021 (an increase on the current recorded population of 12.7 %)[7]. The population projections are trend based projections, which means assumptions for future levels of births, deaths and migration are based on observed levels over the previous five years. They show what the population will be if recent trends in these continue. Since these assumptions are based solely on recent demographic trends, the projections would not reflect the impact of urban extensions such as the New Eastern Villages.

Table 4.5: Population Projections for Swindon Borough

Year	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Population Projections	219,000	222,200	225,300	228,200	231,100	234,000	236,800	239,500

Source: (MKi) Observatory: Regions and Districts – Population Projections 2011-2021

[5] Census 2011: Ethnic Group, published by ONS
[6] Census 2011: Usual Resident Population for Wards, published by ONS
[7] (MKi) Observatory: Regions and Districts – Population Projections 2011-2021.

Housing

4.4.9 The number of households in Swindon has grown since 2001 from 75,293 to 88,590 by 2011 (a 17.5% rise), which is broadly consistent with national trends. Table 4.6 shows the estimated rise in households in Swindon Borough up to 2021. Using ONS data for Blunsdon Ward, the number of households in 2011 was 1,323[8]

Table 4.6: Household Projections for Swindon Borough

Year	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Household Projections	91,471	93,887	94,315	96,685	97,030	98,320	99,615	100,885	102,130

Source: Table 406, Interim 2011-based household projections by district, England 1991-2021.

4.4.10 In 2011 the average household size in Swindon was 2.35; this is projected to reduce slightly to 2.34 in 2016 and to reduce further to 2.33 in 2021[9]

4.4.11 In 2011, 65.5% of dwellings in Swindon Borough were privately owned[10]. Table 4.7 shows the tenure mix for Swindon and compares this with the tenure mix for the South West.

Table 4.7 Dwelling Tenures

	Owned Outright	Owned with a mortgage or loan	Shared Ownership	Rented from Local Authority	Other social rented	Private Rented
Swindon	25.7%	39.8%	1.3%	11.6%	4.7%	16%
South West	35.4%	32%	0.8%	5.8%	7.5%	17.1%

Source: Table QS405EW, 2011 Census- Tenure, Households, Local Authorities in England and Wales

4.4.12 The *Swindon Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2012* states that house prices are lower than in surrounding areas, and indeed vary across Swindon. Average

[8] Table QS481EW, 2011 Census– Dwellings.
[9] Table 427 Change in average household size, local authority districts and England 2011-2021.
[10] Table QS405EW, 2011 Census- Tenure, Households, Local Authorities in England and Wales

house prices are higher in the more rural wards of Ridgeway, Blunsdon, and Wroughton and Chiseldon than in the town. Prices within the town are highest within Old Town and Lawn, whilst Parks, Grass Hill and Pinehurst exhibit the lowest prices. In January 2011 the average house price was £187,000, compared with a regional average of £239,500. Average house prices for different property types typically range from £83,700 for one bedroom flats to £258,400 for a four bedroom house. The SHMA recognises that there are members of the population, particularly on low to modest incomes that are unable to buy, with approximately 35% of first time buyers priced out of the market for a lower-quartile priced flat, 55% for a lower quartile terraced house and almost 64% for a semi-detached house. The figures assume that a mortgage is obtained based upon three times salary levels.

4.4.13 Average rental prices for Swindon are £595 per calendar month and range from an average of £507 pcm for a one bedroom flat and £1,100 for a four bedroom house. [11].

4.4.14 The Swindon SHMA reports 6,166 households classed as being 'in housing need', on SBC's Housing Register, representing 7% of all households in Swindon.

4.4.15 The SHMA predicts that population growth in Swindon will increase demands from all household types. However, the greatest pressure will be from one-person households and those over the age of 85. ONS projections predict that approximately 1300 new homes per year will be needed to meet the demand from new households.

4.4.16 Swindon's net housing completions have steadily decreased from 2260 dwellings in 2006/07 and 1943 in 2007/08 to 968 in 2008/09, 880 in 2009/10 and at its lowest 801 in 2010/11[12].

4.4.17 SBC has revised its housing targets to 2026 to about 22,00 dwellings, to be delivered at an average rate of 1,150 per annum between 2011 and 2016 and increasing to an average annual rate of 1,625 dwellings between 2016 and 2026.

Employment

[11] Swindon Market Rent Summary (June 2013) www.home.co.uk

[12] Annual Monitoring Report 2010-2011, Swindon Borough Council.

4.4.18 The draft *Swindon Borough Local Plan (2012)* confirms Swindon's historic economic success, a product of its advantageous strategic location, the diversity and resilience of key economic sectors within the Borough, good land availability, comparatively low commercial property prices and high business start-up rates.

Table 4.8 Economic Activity

All people	Blunsdon Ward	Swindon	South West	England
Economically active	70.8%	76%	70.3%	69.9%
Employee Full Time	36.6%	46.7%	37.4%	38.6%
Employee Part Time	13.9%	14.4%	15.1%	13.7%
Self Employed	14.7%	7.8%	11.2%	9.7%

Source: Table QS601EW, 2011 Census – Economic Activity.

4.4.19 Table 4.8 shows that 76% of the population of Swindon is defined as economically active, compared with 70.8% of the population of Blunsdon Ward. The proportion of economically active people is also higher in Swindon than in the South West (70.3%) and England (69.9%).

4.4.20 A distinctive character of the ward is the high proportion of its population that are self employed, 14.7 % of its usual residents aged 16 to 74, considerably higher than in Swindon, the South West and England as a whole.

Table 4.9 Economic Inactivity (Jan 2012-Dec 2012)

All people	Swindon	South West	Great Britain
Economically Inactive	20.6%	21.6%	23.1%

Source: NOMIS: Swindon Labour Market Profile www.nomisweb.co.uk

4.4.21 Table 4.9 shows Swindon to have a lower rate of economic inactivity compared with the South West and nationally. As an indicator of economic inactivity, in 2013, only 1.3 % of all residents aged 16-64 in Blunsdon Ward were claiming Job Seekers Allowance, compared with 3.3 % of Swindon residents and 3.7% nationally[13].

[13] Nomis: ONS Source: claimant count with rates and proportions

4.4.22 Educational achievements are lower in Swindon compared with the rest of the South West and nationally, with 22.7% of the population (aged 16 and over) gaining NVQ4 level and above compared with 27.4% in the South West and 27.3% nationally, Swindon has the lowest percentage of workers qualified to NVQ4 level of all unitary and district authorities in the South West

4.4.23 The population of Blunsdon Ward is well educated, with 28.1% of the population gaining NVQ4 level and above, which exceeds the percentage for Swindon and compares favourably with the South West and England[14].

4.4.24 The highest proportion of Swindon residents is employed in the service sector (81.4%). Within this sector, 25.4% are employed in finance, IT and other business activities and 24.7% are employed within distribution, hotel and restaurant activities. Following the service sector, the second largest employment sector is manufacturing, employing 13.2% of Swindon's workforce[15].

4.4.25 ONS data analysing flows of commuters between local authorities identifies that 80 % of the working population of Swindon work within the Borough, with a further 4% commuting to Wiltshire, 2% to Cheltenham and 1 % to Gloucester.

4.4.26 Swindon has attracted considerable inward investment from national and international firms, including Honda, BMW, Zurich, Nationwide, WH Smith and the National Trust. The *Economic Strategy for Swindon 2012-26* sets out key drivers for Swindon's growth, including its excellent strategic location which enables it to draw on an extensive labour market along the M4 corridor and Great Western rail route. Of further advantage is Swindon's location on the M4/A419 intersection coupled with the town being a well established centre for logistics and distribution. Swindon has also exhibited growth in low carbon technologies and engineering.

4.4.27 The *Economic Strategy for Swindon 2012-2026* (2013) addresses the need to stimulate and support an early return to employment creation. The priorities identified in the Economic Strategy and Action Plan are driven by the need to focus activities and investment where there is greatest potential to secure new jobs for the Borough.

[14] Table QS501EW Highest Level of Qualification, 2011
15 Source: ONS annual business inquiry employee analysis, Employee jobs (2008)

4.4.28 The Strategy reports Swindon to be a productive economy with one of the highest gross value added per capita figures amongst locations outside London. However, youth unemployment has become a particularly acute problem with 26% of those who are unemployed being aged between 16 and 24[16]. The Borough's skills are considered to be well matched to the current economy, in which manufacturing, logistics/distribution and consumer services play a large part. However, the Borough is a relatively lower skilled location where a relatively high proportion of residents has fewer skills.

4.4.29 The *Economic Strategy for Swindon* considers that Swindon's excellent location enables it to draw on an extensive labour market and as such should be well placed to capture a share of future economic growth in south east/south west England. The Strategy also reports that Swindon represents a cost competitive location, in which house prices are lower than in many areas, also comparing favourably to other locations in terms of commercial property prices.

4.4.30 The Strategy sets out six core priorities to shape Swindon's economy in the future which include:

- creating a place of opportunity for young people;
- developing Swindon's higher education provision;
- positioning Swindon as a hub of engineering and manufacturing technology;
- revitalising Swindon Town Centre;
- establishing Swindon as a regional leisure destination; and
- creating a low carbon Swindon.

4.4.31 There are a number of existing employment sites that are located in close proximity to the Site, which include: South Marston Park, with a site area of 93.35 Ha; Keypoint at South Marston, with an area of 24.54Ha; and Thornhill, South Marston, with an area of 5.22 Ha.

[16] Table KS601EW, 2011 Economic Activity, Local Authorities in England

Education

4.4.32 Within Swindon, there are 42 primary schools, 2 secondary schools, 29 academies and 5 special schools. There is one primary school in South Marston, with 107 pupils currently on the roll. The nearest secondary school to the Site is Kingsdown School with 1213 students currently on the roll. [17]

Table 4.10 East Swindon Schools

Primary School	Forms of Entry
Beechcroft	3
Colebrook	1.67
Covingham	2
Eldene	2
Goddard Park	2
Grange	3
Liden	2
Nythe	1
South Marston	0.5
Total Existing Capacity	**17.2**
Secondary School	**Forms of Entry**
Kingsdown	8.4
Dorcan College	7.3
Total Existing Capacity	***15.75***

Source: School Place Planning Study Future Demand Update (March 2011), Table 11 – East Swindon Schools

4.4.33 Forecasts to 2026, for the east of Swindon, without the proposed Local Plan growth, anticipate a surplus of school pupils below the capacity of Kingsdown and Dorcan , this surplus is around 1FE. Based on birth rates in the area (as at March 2011), there is surplus capacity of up to 2.6 FE across the primary schools in the Kingsdown and Dorcan area.

4.4.34 The significant planned growth of Swindon as set out in the submitted draft Local Plan 2026 will generate the need for increases in education provision across the Borough. The *School Place Planning Study Future Demand* (April 2009) and its

[17] School Population Brochure, January 2013, Swindon Borough Council.

2011 update, reports the growth as set out in the submitted Local Plan, generating a need for 22 forms-of-entry at primary and secondary school level across the town (form-of-entry generally means a class size of 30 pupils). The report discusses the need to provide school places for the long term when the population stabilises but also to manage the temporary short term peaks, which can arise from the relatively lower cost of newer homes being particularly attractive to young families.

4.4.35 The *School Place Planning Study Future Demand (2011 Update)* calculated the demand for additional school places in the East Swindon area, taking into account current school capacity, existing pressure on school places, planned growth and the temporary peak. This is set out below.

Table 4.11 East Swindon School Place Demand

	Capacity	Existing pressure*	Demand from new housing growth	Demand for places	Peak	Demand for places including the Peak
Primary	17.2 FE	-2.6 FE	9.25 FE	6.65 FE	4.63 FE	11.28 FE
Secondary	15.7 FE	-1 FE	9.25 FE	8.25 FE	4.63 FE	12.88 FE

* Above capacity (taking existing surplus into account)

Source: School Place Planning Study Future Demand Update (March 2011) Table 12 –East School Place Demand.

4.4.36 There are surplus school places in East Swindon at present. However, the planned development of the NEV will generate demand for considerably more places than those currently available.

4.4.37 Draft Policy NC3 proposes a minimum of 8 forms-of-entry secondary school provision, a minimum of 8 forms-of-entry primary school provision with early learning facilities, a site for a special school for people with profound, multiple and severe learning difficulties for ages 0-25, and measures to manage the demographic peak at primary and secondary schools. Draft Local Plan Policy RA3 proposes delivery of

primary school places within the village to meet the needs of an expanded South Marston.

Health and Health Facilities

4.4.38 The Site is within the administrative area of NHS Swindon, which employs over 750 staff directly, providing primary care services through independent contractors. There are 27 GP practices which accommodate 90 GP partners and 36 salaried GPs. There are 22 dentistry practices which accommodate 44 dentists. There is also urgent dental care through Dental Access Centre (a community dental service). Optician services are provided in 17 premises and pharmaceutical services are available from 41 pharmacy locations operated by 25 pharmacy provider organisations[18].

4.4.39 The Investment and Asset Management Strategy reports a current average of 2,200 patients per Whole Time Equivalent (WTE) GP, and estimates a future provision of an additional 10 WTE GPs by 2016. However, Swindon has a target list size of 1,700 patients per WTE GP, closer to the UK standard of 1,800 people per GP[19], and as such requires a further 30 WTE GPs by 2016, increasing to 42 WTE GPs to meets the needs of the 2026 population.

4.4.40 Swindon Clinical Commissioning Group (CCG) is a new organisation within the NHS, which from 1 April 2013 is responsible for procuring health services for Swindon. Swindon CCG is responsible for commissioning NHS services for 219,000 people. Swindon CCG has £235m of funding available to improve the health of residents within its catchment area, with the majority of the budget spent on hospital care, community and mental health services, GP and dental services, and prescribed medicines.[20].

4.4.41 The Care Quality Commission's Annual Health Check reported the overall quality of services for Great Western Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust and Swindon PCT as 'good'. However of the 12 Ambulance Services in England, Great Western had the

[18] Commissioners' Investment and Asset Management Strategy v 5.1, 2010-2014
[19] Department of Health & NHS (best practice guide) *Department of Health & NHS London (2010); 2012 Health Needs Assessment Initiation Workshop – Presentation Slides [London – Central Hall, Westminster, 13 March 2009).*
[20] Swindon Clinical Commissioning Group http://www.swindonccg.nhs.uk, Accessed 10 June 2013

fourth lowest response rate for 8 minute response times and the second lowest rate for 19 minute response times in 2010/11. Both rates have improved from the previous year[21].

4.4.42 The *Investment and Asset Management Strategy* reports that due to the severe effect of the recession on Swindon's working population and the increase in numbers now seeking Jobseekers Allowance, there are increased pressures on health and social care provision through stress and mental illness, decreased ability to pay for private health care and to self fund social care, and increases in families and children living in poverty.

4.4.43 Active Swindon Strategy 2009-2015, Swindon NHS reports the projected increase in Swindon's population, especially within the middle-aged and older cohorts. The number of people aged 65+ is projected to increase by 34% and the number of people aged 85+ by 45.2% by 2016. There is also projected to be a notable surge (a 30% increase) of people in their 20's.

4.4.44 Generally the health of people in Swindon is mixed compared with the England average. Deprivation is lower than average. However, 7,300 children live in poverty. Life expectancy for both men and women is similar to the England average. However, within the most deprived areas, it is 8.9 years lower for men and 6.5 years lower for women. Over the last 10 years, mortality rates have fallen and early death rates from cancer and from heart disease and stroke have fallen. Levels of alcohol-specific hospital stays among those under 18 are worse than the England average, whereas levels of teenage pregnancy and smoking in pregnancy are better than the England average.[22]

4.4.45 There are a number of health priorities for Swindon, which include improving mental wellbeing, increasing the uptake of childhood immunisations and tackling obesity and diabetes. The *Active Swindon Strategy* (2009) reports that Swindon has a greater prevalence of overweight children than England as a whole and as such aims to increase levels of physical activity, reduce obesity and improve the lives of people living in Swindon.

[21] South West Observatory Core Unit, January 2012
[22] Health Profile Swindon 2012, English Public Health Observatories.

4.4.46 The nearest surgery to the Site is Merchiston Surgery, Highworth Road, Stratton St Margaret, less than 3 miles from the Site which cares for approximately 13,000 patients shared between 10 GPs and is currently accepting new patients.

4.4.47 Other doctors surgeries within 5 miles of the Site, which are currently accepting new patients include[23]:

- Elm Tree Surgery, High Street, Shrivenham;
- Eldene Surgery, Colingsmead, Eldene, Swindon;
- Penhill Surgery, 257 Penhill Drive, Swindon;
- Hawthorn Medical Centre, May Close, Swindon; and
- Kingswood Surgery, Kingswood Avenue, Swindon.

4.4.48 Doctors surgeries currently not accepting new patients are:

- Crossroads Surgery, 478 Cricklade Road, Swindon; and
- Westrop Surgery, Highworth, Swindon.

4.4.49 Dentist practices within 5 miles of the Site, which are currently accepting new patients, include:

- Smile Dental Care, Eldene Health Centre, Eldene, Swindon
- Whitecross Dental Care Limited, 93-97 Cricklade Road, Swindon
- Park South Dental Practice, Priory Road Medical Centre, Park South, Swindon

4.4.50 Private dental surgeries and pharmacies are delivered under open market conditions and are based on the strength of local demand. Therefore, it is assumed that where demand exceeds supply, the gap will be met by an individual pharmacist or dentist opening a shop/clinic in the area.

4.4.51 The nearest large hospital is the Great Western Hospital, which provides 24 hour accident and emergency, maternity, stroke and heart and a range of outpatient services. The hospital is relatively new, although the NHS Trust has identified a need for further land to accommodate the population growth adjacent to the Great Western Hospital[24]

[23] www.nhs.gov.uk (accessed 10 June 2013)
[24] Draft Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026

4.4.52 There are care homes just outside South Marston and at Stratton St Margaret.

4.4.53 The *Investment and Access Management Strategy* confirms an arrangement for health care services to be delivered in local communities wherever possible, supported collaboratively by practice based commissioners and health and social care providers.

4.4.54 The submitted draft Local Plan Policy NC3 requires a health care facility with GP, dentist and pharmacy accommodation to be provided within the district centre, in order to serve the NEV, including the Proposed Development.

Open Space, Sport and Leisure

4.4.55 The Borough contains over 150 parks and open spaces for outdoor recreation. These include the country parks of Lydiard, Coate Water, Mouldon Hill, Stanton and Barbury Castle, as well as the urban parks of Mannington, Town Gardens, The Lawns and Faringdon Road Park.

4.4.56 There is a good distribution of sports facilities across Swindon. Sports facilities include the Oasis, the Link Centre, Croft Sports Centre, Dorcan Recreational Complex, the Health Hydro, the County Ground and Haydon Centre, also including tennis, golf and other specialist sports facilities.[25]

4.4.57 The draft Local Plan acknowledges the importance of increasing local access to both indoor and outdoor sports and playing pitches by promoting use of school and college facilities by the wider community, reducing costs and supporting the role of schools at the heart of their community.

4.4.58 *The Strategy for Major Sports Facilities Swindon 2009-2026* has identified a number of objectives to deliver a network of specialist sports centres, to include: re-development of Oasis as a regional leisure facility; enhancement of the County Ground with a focus on athletics and cricket; enhancement of Esprit Academy with a specialist focus on gymnastics; and enhancement of the Link Centre with a focus on swimming and ice sports.

[25] Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026: Submission Document June 2013.

4.4.59 The Borough has a good level of access to a diverse range of open space. However, there is an unequal provision of open space within local communities. SBC's *Open Space Audit and Assessment Review*, July 2011 highlights these shortfalls and provides an assessment of the quality and accessibility of open space.

4.4.60 Policy EN3 of the draft Swindon Borough Local Plan sets out the public open space standards required for all development of 25 dwellings or more, a standard of 3.2 hectares per 1,000 population. This amount is to be provided through children's and teenagers' play areas, outdoor sports facilities, general recreation areas and allotments.

4.4.61 Swindon's play area design standards are based on the latest standards within *Planning and Design for Outdoor Sport and Play – Fields in Trust (FIT)* 2012, which provides design guidance for the function and layout of Local Equipped Areas for Play (LEAP) and Neighbourhood Equipped Areas for Play (NEAP).

4.4.62 SBC has published a Green Infrastructure (GI) Strategy[26] which reports the network of accessible multifunctional sites to include parks, woodland, informal open spaces, nature reserves and historic sites, as well as linkages, such as river and wildlife corridors. The GI network provides biodiverse habitats as well as improving access to recreation and tourism opportunities.

4.4.63 The Ward analysis for Blunsdon reports a surplus of total open space however a large amount of this total is located within one or two general recreational spaces. The average quality does meet the standard with a few of the sites scoring above the standard. Access varies throughout the ward, with playspaces provided in all villages however there are only a few recreational spaces therefore a lack of access in some areas[27].

4.4.64 The Open Space Audit reports a surplus of total open space in Blunsdon, including 74 Ha of general recreation land within the Blunsdon Ward, 0.26 Ha of children's play space, 1.8 hectares of outdoor sports facilities and 0.55 Ha of allotments. However, a large amount of this total is located within one or two general recreational spaces.

[26] A Green Infrastructure Strategy for Swindon 2010-2026, Revised Consultation Document 2011.
[27] Open Space Audit and Assessment Review, Swindon Borough Council(July 2011)

The average quality is reported to be at standard, with South Marston Recreation ground scoring above standard for quality. .Access varies across the ward, with play spaces provided in all villages. However, there are only a few recreational spaces, such that there is a lack of access in some areas[28].

4.4.65 In order to meet the needs of the growing population, the Audit encourages the flexible use of semi-natural spaces to provide more recreational opportunities, including opportunities to improve connectivity.

4.4.66 South Marston has a recreation area (2.34 Ha) located on the south eastern edge of the village, adjacent to the primary school. The village allotments are located at the northern edge of the village, on the Highworth Road.

4.4.67 Nightingale Wood, to the east of the Site, is a general recreation area and County Wildlife Site. Oxleaze Wood, to the south west of the village and St. Julian's Woodland, north of Thornhill Road, are recently planted community woodlands.

4.4.68 Natural England's aspirational Accessible Natural Greenspace Standards (ANGSt) set out a number of recommendations that include:

- At least 1 hectare of Local Nature Reserve per 1,000 population;
- Every person should live no further than 300m from the nearest area of natural green space of at least 2 hectares;
- 1 accessible 20 hectare green space site within 2 km from home;
- 1 accessible 100 hectare green space site within 5 km;
- 1 accessible 500 hectare green space site within 10 km.

Community Facilities

4.4.69 Swindon has a good mix of community facilities, including community halls, libraries, places of worship, a number of museums including the Great Western Railway Museum, Swindon Arts Centre and a theatre.

[28] Open Space Audit and Assessment, Ward Profiles 2011 – Part B

4.4.70 South Marston Village Hall provides a venue for Parish meetings and local community events and is owned and managed by the Parish Council and a local charity. The primary school also provides a playgroup facility for parents and their babies/toddlers. There is a youth club, gardening/allotment club, walking club and business club. South Marston also has a church, two public houses, and a hotel and conference venue.

4.4.71 The nearest post office to the Site is in Stratton St Margaret while the nearest libraries are at Covingham and Upper Stratton. In addition there is a mobile library that serves the settlements around Swindon, including South Marston.

4.4.72 Policy NC3 of the emerging Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026 refers to a requirement for provision of community facilities within the NEV..

4.4.73 The police force responsible for policing and crime prevention in the area is Wiltshire County Council. The Swindon operational hub is at Gablecross, adjacent to the Site, and the Site is within the area of the Swindon East Neighbourhood Policing Team[29].

4.4.74 Wiltshire Fire and Rescue are responsible for fire services within Swindon. Swindon is covered by three fire stations, the nearest to the Site being at Stratton[30]. Policy NC3 of the emerging Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026 refers to a requirement for safeguarded land for a fire station at the southern end of the NEV.

4.4.75 Policy CM3 refers to a redistribution of emergency service assets to include the provision of new fire stations and co-location with other emergency services, particularly the ambulance service to manage the planned growth.

Deprivation

4.4.76 Swindon is a broadly average area in terms of prosperity. The average weekly income for a full time employee in Swindon is £508 which is equal to the average weekly wages for Great Britain[31].

[29] www.wiltshire.policy.uk

[30] Wiltshire Fire & Rescue Service's Community Risk Strategy for Swindon Borough from 2006-2026.

[31] ONS annual survey of hours and earnings – resident analysis (2012)

4.4.77 There are 119 Lower Super Output Areas (LSOAs) in the Swindon Unitary Authority area, according to the Indices of Multiple Deprivation 2010. 18 of these 119 areas are among the most deprived 20% nationally. A further 9 of these 18 areas are also within the most deprived 10% nationally. The most prevalent form of deprivation in Swindon relates to education, skills and training[32].

4.4.78 Blunsdon Ward exhibits socio-economic characteristics that reveal it to be one of Swindon's more affluent wards. The average weekly household total income for households within Blunsdon Ward is £650, more than £140 higher than the averages across Swindon and Great Britain[33]. The number of households within Blunsdon with two or more cars is very high (41.3%), compared with a Swindon average of 27.2%[34]

Retail

4.4.79 The submitted Local Plan refers to Swindon's town centre as poorly performing, specifically in terms of its retail offer. Swindon town centre is a fairly compact centre. The main shopping streets include Havelock Square, Regent Street, Canal Walk, The Parade, Bridge Street and Fleet Street. In the centre of the shopping area is the Brunel Shopping Centre and The Parade which is anchored by a Debenhams Store and containing a number of national and multiple retailers. The Old Town offers a selection of more niche independent shops and cafes. McArthurGlen Swindon Designer Outlet provides high street and designer brands. There are also retail parks in Greenbridge, Northern Orbital and West Swindon. Indeed, there is twice as much retail floorspace outside of the town centre than currently present in the centre[35].

4.4.80 The *Swindon Town Centre Health Check* (2010) reports that although overall Swindon is by no means an unhealthy or failing town centre, evidence over the past several years confirms that it has consistently been unable to fulfil its potential. The town centre has a lower than average amount of units and floorspace occupied by convenience retail uses and the proportion of units occupied by comparison retailers

[32] South West Observatory Core Unit, June 2011
[33] ONS Model Based Estimates (2005)
[34] ONS Table QS416EW, car or van availability, 2011
[35] Swindon Town Centre Health Check 2010

is below all average levels, although the proportion of floorspace is commensurate with regional and comparable town averages and above the national average level.

4.4.81 The number of multiple retailers in the town centre over the past two years has increased in the service sector but declined in the convenience and comparison sectors. The proportion of comparison uses is below the regional and comparable town averages but above the national average.

4.4.82 Swindon is now being outperformed in terms of retailer requirements by all surrounding and comparable towns, with the exception of Basingstoke and Telford.

4.4.83 The submission Local Plan reports the regeneration of Swindon Town Centre as a top priority for Swindon, with a key part of this regeneration focusing on a strong Retail Core which will represent Swindon's Primary Shopping Area, as defined in Annexe 2 of the National Planning Policy Framework. The Swindon Retail Capacity Update 2009 indicates a potential for Swindon Town Centre to accommodate around 53,700sqm of comparison goods floor space by 2026. *Swindon Central Area Action Plan Development Plan Document* (2009), provides the detailed policy framework to deliver Swindon's regeneration.

Public Safety

4.4.84 In 2010/11 Swindon had the fourth highest overall crime rate of the 16 county and unitary authorities in the South West with a crime rate of 43.1 offences per 1,000 population, higher than the rate for the South West (33.8 per 1,000), but comparable with the average crime rate for England and Wales[36.]

Projected Baseline

4.4.85 There are unlikely to be any significant changes in baseline conditions if the Proposed Development does not proceed.

[36] South West Observatory Core Unit, Swindon local Profiles 2012

4.5 POTENTIAL EFFECTS

Construction stage

4.5.1 This section identifies the potential direct and indirect effects the Proposed Development is likely to have on existing and future residents, users and visitors; and assesses the significance of these effects both during and after construction.

Effects during demolition and construction

4.5.2 As noted in **Chapter 2** of this ES, it is expected that the Proposed Development will be developed over a period of approximately 12 years.. A Construction Environmental Management Plan (CEMP) will be adopted that will ensure that any environmental issues arising during the construction stage of the Proposed Development will be dealt with appropriately and in accordance with relevant legislation and to minimise disruption to existing communities.

4.5.3 The Proposed Development will be completed in various stages during which there will be a significant generation of construction related employment. However, the phased development will result in potential effects being spread over time and across the Site as not all areas will be affected at the same time and to the same extent. It is assumed that social infrastructure will be delivered in parallel with the residential element of the Proposed Development, secured by a Section 106 legal agreement attached to any planning permission.

4.5.4 Significant effects on population, housing, education, health and other community facilities are not expected during the demolition and construction stage other than as are assessed below at the operational stage.

4.5.5 It is estimated that the total construction costs for the built development and infrastructure will amount to £350 million (approximately £146,000 per dwelling). If assuming that labour costs associated with the construction and completion of the Proposed Development are at an average of 30% of the total development costs, then labour costs would be circa £105 million.

4.5.6 To establish the effect of the construction phase in terms of direct additional employment in Swindon, the associated labour costs are divided by the average cost of construction labour, based on an average wage of £530 per week[37], giving a salary of £27,500. From this it can be estimated that the development could yield up to3,818 person-years direct additional employment.

4.5.7 A further method of assessing the impact of the construction phase upon employment is for the total construction cost (£350m) to be divided by the average turnover per employee in the construction sector in the UK (which was £113,650 in 2009[38]), resulting in up to 3,100 person-years of construction employment.

4.5.8 The Proposed Development is assumed to spread over a period of around 12 years, thereby directly creating up to around 250 construction job opportunities per year.

4.5.9 Notwithstanding the direct construction job creation as referred to above, there would also be indirect effects through the supply of materials from local businesses and the expenditure of salaries in the wider locality. It is considered likely that most of these companies would be located within Swindon and the surrounding areas. Indeed, most construction workers are likely to be employed from the local labour market which would promote beneficial effects within this area. This increase in spending and job creation would also be experienced by those companies who are indirectly benefiting from the construction of the Proposed Development, such as building suppliers/ merchants.

4.5.10 There are opportunities to establish new and maximise existing local supply chains, particularly if the material selection could incorporate an element of local sourcing where appropriate/ available.

4.5.11 It is considered appropriate to apply a conservative 1.2 employment multiplier to the FTE construction employment, as referred to above, indicating an additional 300 or so indirect jobs could potentially be created through the construction phases of the Proposed Development and the increase in local expenditure.

[37] Source: Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings (ASHE) - Office for National Statistics Median gross weekly earnings by industry, April 2011
[38] BIS Small and Medium Enterprise Statistics, 2009

4.5.12 In the light of the above, it can be concluded that the potential direct and indirect effects of the construction works upon job creation and expenditure would be **temporary**, of **local to regional scale** and of **moderate beneficial** significance.

Post-Completion

Effects on population

4.5.13 As set out earlier in this chapter the average household size in Swindon, according to the 2011 Census data is 2.35 people per household. As such, it is expected that the resident population created by the proposed 2,380 new homes will be about 5,593 persons, an increase of 2.67 % above the existing population of Swindon. With regard to the expansion of South Marston, 580 new dwellings are proposed, resulting in about additional 1,363 persons which represents an increase of nearly 184 % above the current assumed population of 740 residents of South Marston (based on a current housing stock figure of 315 dwellings as identified within the draft South Marston SPD).

4.5.14 The additional population figure as referred to above is based on the assumption that all of the new households would come from outside the Borough. In reality, some of the new homes are likely to be occupied by existing local residents buying first homes, residents trading up or downsizing, or people on waiting lists for affordable housing. Such relocation of existing residents would free up existing dwellings for occupation by other new residents, adding to the total population.

4.5.15 When considered over the 12 year assumed development timescale, these increases are of a significant scale, particularly in the light of the very limited growth in population in South Marston over the last 20 years.

4.5.16 The income and spend of the new residents in the local economy will increase local GVA which will have positive indirect effects upon the local Swindon economy. The Proposed Development will deliver up to 2,380 new dwellings. Assuming that this would support up to 2,380 new households at South Marston and Rowborough and the average annual income for Swindon is £26,416, it can be assumed that the development has the potential of supporting approximately £62,870,080 per annum of gross household income to be spent within the local economy.

4.5.17 The impacts on existing businesses, in particular within the town centre, will be beneficial as the Proposed Development does not contain any large scale retail uses and, as such, avoids competition with the town centre. Furthermore, the new residents will also help to sustain the retail and business elements proposed at the District Centre within the NEV.

4.5.18 The broader range of housing opportunities is expected to make a positive contribution to helping to provide a better balance in the local population including through the provision of larger homes to encourage economically active migrants into the community, increasing housing opportunities at South Marston.

4.5.19 The wider effects of such population growth will depend on a range of other factors, such as the impact such growth has on local infrastructure such as health and education. New residents within the Proposed Development are likely to affect the demand for key community services (e.g. education in particular) within the immediate environs of the Site. These direct effects will not necessarily be adverse, provided adequate levels of community infrastructure are delivered to meet the additional needs arising from the Proposed Development.

4.5.20 It is clear that the magnitude of the impact will reflect the geographic area affected, for example the scale of the impact is assumed to have a lesser effect on the population at the Borough-wide level compared with the existing population of South Marston village.

4.5.21 On this basis, the effect of the population increase, in particular on the regeneration of the town, is considered to be **permanent**, of **local to regional** scale and of **major beneficial** significance, provided the necessary social infrastructure such as education, health, community facilities and open space is delivered insofar as this is necessary and in a timely manner. This will be assessed further in the following paragraphs.

Effects on the housing market

4.5.22 The Proposed Development would have a direct impact on the housing market by providing an increase in the current housing stock. The mix of dwellings will be fixed through subsequent Reserved Matters approvals pursuant to any Outline planning

permission. The emphasis will include family housing but smaller units will also be provided, including the potential for an element of sheltered housing aimed towards older persons in line with the future local housing needs and demand as identified in the SHMA.

4.5.23 Some 20% and 30% of the new dwellings is sought as affordable housing in the emerging Local Plan. The precise nature of the affordable housing provision including mix of tenures (to include affordable rent) and house types, will be subject to negotiation and detailed agreement with SBC.

4.5.24 The number, type and tenure of the dwellings that the Proposed Development would provide would have a beneficial impact in terms of meeting the diverse housing needs of the existing and new residents of Swindon. In particular, the affordable housing provided would help address the accommodation needs of those residents currently on the SBC waiting list.

4.5.25 The Proposed Development would also help improve the choice and availability of market housing in the Borough. Increasing the supply and diversity of market housing would assist residents, particularly on low to modest incomes that are unable to buy within Swindon and are currently restricted from entering the market, to afford to buy their first house.

4.5.26 The Proposed Development would provide a range of affordable housing types to help meet the housing needs predicted by SBC. f

4.5.27 The Proposed Development will also be likely provide new homes for workers employed within the 40 hectare employment allocation proposed at the NEV, south of the A420.

4.5.28 The interim 2011- based sub-national population projections published by Office of National Statistics in 2012, confirm a growth in the population of Swindon over the next 15 years. New housing as a result of the Proposed Development would help meet directly the expected demand from more households seeking accommodation in the Borough. Indirectly, the Proposed Development will lessen the pressure on housing markets elsewhere, thereby increasing choice and affordability at local, district and regional level.

4.5.29 On this basis both the direct and indirect effects of the Proposed Development on the local and regional housing market will be **permanent**, of **local to regional** scale and of **major beneficial significance** for the long term development of the area.

Effects on employment

Direct Employment

4.5.30 The Site is currently undeveloped and therefore offers few existing jobs; any employment that does exist is in agriculture and farming.

4.5.31 The Proposed Development includes a local centre and a second area of mixed use development, both of which are envisaged to accommodate elements of retail and employment and could accommodate community uses, which will create a modest number of jobs. Additional jobs will also be created by the proposed primary school and the South Marston school expansion, and through the management of open spaces and sports facilities within the Proposed Development.

4.5.32 The Proposed Development includes a mix of land uses including residential, commercial, community, sheltered housing, education and open space. The Proposed Development is expected to deliver up to 428 jobs spread across these uses, as set out below.

Table 4.12: Job creation (based on HCA Employment Densities Guide, 2010, except where identified)

Employment Provider	Floorspace (sqm)	Job/ sqm	Job Creation
Local Retail (A1)	2500	1/19	132
Employment Land	2500	1/12	208
Village Hall/Community Centre	1200	1/36	33
Sheltered Housing	Up to 20 beds	n/a	2
Primary Schools	630 places	11.9 jobs per pupil[39]	53

[39] Based on the Department of Education (DoE) School Workforce in England 2011 average of 11.9 pupils per adult in primary schools.

4.5.33 These new jobs will offer employment opportunities for a wide range of skill levels, including management, professional health and education staff, clerical/administrative and sales staff, as well as skilled and semi-skilled jobs. The proposals will create a mix of full-time, permanent jobs as well as flexible part-time opportunities on site. Based on experience and for the purpose of this ES it is assumed that 80% of all jobs will be full time while 20% will be part time. On this basis about 342 jobs will be full time and 86 will be part time.

4.5.34 Based on the assumption of 1 job per 19 sq m of retail space, up to 132 jobs could be created solely by the quantum of A1 floorspace as proposed within the new mixed use local centre and secondary mixed use centre. This figure is an estimate only and is dependent upon the nature of the businesses that occupy the particular units .In addition to the A1 uses, it is anticipated that the neighbourhood and local centres include an element of A2, A3, A4 and A5 uses, of a quantum as yet to be defined. These uses will generate further employment opportunities.

4.5.35 The employment uses will fall solely within the B1 use class, equating to 1 job per 12 sq m of floor space, yielding a potential to create some 208 jobs within the Proposed Development.

4.5.36 The proposed primary school at Rowborough will provide up to 2 forms of entry and the expansion of the South Marston Primary school will provide a further 1 form of entry. This will yield approximately 53 jobs, including teachers and supporting staff.

4.5.37 A community facility/ sports hall is to be provided to serve the existing and proposed residents of South Marston. The building is envisaged to cover a floor area of up to 1200 sq m, with a potential to create some 33 jobs although this is likely to be a significant overestimate.

4.5.38 A small element of sheltered housing is anticipated, to provide accommodation for older and which would be located close to neighbouring amenities.

4.5.39 There will be a small loss of existing jobs resulting from the cessation of the agricultural tenancies on the Site. However, the scale of this loss is not significant in overall socio-economic terms. In addition, jobs will be created in the management of

the open spaces, and in other services that have not been reflected in the estimates above. Nor do the above estimates include employment based at home..

4.5.40 An estimate of up to 428 jobs, as set out in Table 4.12, will therefore arise directly from the Proposed Development. At this stage, it is not possible to project a more accurate employment figure or establish the precise mix of employment types.

4.5.41 A proportion of existing residents of South Marston could find employment within the Proposed Development, or to the south of the A420 within the 40 hectares of employment land proposed as part of the allocation of the NEV..

Indirect Employment

4.5.42 Indirect jobs will be supported by the increased expenditure on goods, supplies and services provided by companies in the surrounding area and will support induced employment in local shops, services and other firms.

4.5.43 The Proposed Development will provide housing for about 4251 economically active people (based on the 2011 rate of economic activity of all residents in Swindon). Based on a 12 year delivery programme, this will add some 352 economically active residents to the Borough each year. This will be offset by some existing residents of the Borough becoming no longer economically active, primarily through retirement. The addition of economically active residents will have a positive economic effect on the local area.

4.5.44 Based on the characteristics of the Proposed Development, its local economic context and labour market, a multiplier of 200 jobs per 1,000 additional residents is considered appropriate to estimate indirect and induced employment in the area, which equates to 1119 additional jobs in local shops and services.

Overall Economic Effects

4.5.45 In summary, the most significant effects of the Proposed Development on the local economy, at the time of completion, would be:

- a significant capital investment that will not only finance the Proposed Development but also boost the local economy by providing trade for local businesses (e.g. construction companies and suppliers);
- up to an additional circa 428 direct permanent job opportunities on site;
- up to an approximate 1119 new additional indirect FTE jobs in local shops and services;
- a mix of full time and part time employment opportunities for a wide range of skill levels

4.5.46 The effects of the Proposed Development on the local labour market are therefore assessed as being **permanent**, of **local to regional** scale, and of **moderate beneficial** significance, due to the scale and quality of jobs that will be created and the positive economic impacts over the baseline.

Effects on education facilities

4.5.47 The impact of the Proposed Development on education provision in the local area will depend on the number of additional children of school age generated by the 2,380 new dwellings, the availability of spare school places in the area and general trends in schoolchildren numbers in the area over the period of housing delivery.

4.5.48 The *Swindon School Place Planning Study Update* (2011) sets out a methodology used to predict the number of school places required to meet the education needs of the growing population. It assumes multipliers of 0.231 primary school children and 0.165 secondary school children would be generated by each dwelling. On this basis the development would therefore give rise to 550 primary school aged children (aged 5-11 years) and 393 secondary aged children (11-18 years). With regards to early years provision, it can be calculated that there are likely to be up to 157 3-4 year olds (2/7 of 550) requiring Early Years education.

4.5.49 Whilst there is some existing capacity within the existing junior schools as identified within the 'East' school place planning zone, it cannot meet the school place demand that would be generated by the Proposed Development, especially taking into account the school place needs resulting from the wider allocation of 8,000 dwellings

of which the Proposed Development forms part. Additional school provision will be required to accommodate the additional children generated by the development.

4.5.50 The Proposed Development therefore includes provision for a primary school on site at Rowborough. The site of approximately 2 hectares is sufficient to accommodate a two form entry (420-place) school. There will also be a 1FE extension to the South Marston Village school, accommodating a further 210 places. Some pre-school provision is likely to be associated with Rowborough school but it may not necessarily be directly managed by the school.

4.5.51 The Proposed Development will cater for the number of primary school children it generates, with sufficient surplus capacity to help reduce pressure on existing schools in north/east Swindon and surrounding areas. Rowborough school is intended to be built at an appropriate point to be agreed with the local authority, to avoid placing too much pressure on the existing primary school at South Marston village. In the period before Rowborough primary school is built, it is envisaged that the Proposed Development may use either existing or temporary additional capacity in existing primary schools to accommodate the children of initial new residents .

4.5.52 In addition, it should be noted that some of the new residents will relocate to the Proposed Development from within the Borough and their children might continue to attend their existing schools. However, others might consider relocating to the new schools, thereby freeing up spaces in existing schools as an indirect effect. Another indirect effect of the new schools will be the creation of jobs for teachers and support staff, and the additional spend on books, stationery and school uniforms.

4.5.53 It is considered that there is some capacity in the local area to accommodate the number of secondary school children generated by the earlier phases of the Proposed Development. At present, there is the equivalent of 1 FE of surplus capacity at Dorcan College and Kingsdown, which the Swindon School Place Planning Study Update 2011 identifies will help manage the pressure on school places in the short term, and could provide 210 of the required 393 secondary school places.

4.5.54 There is of course a requirement to meet the secondary education needs of the pupils generated by the later phases of the Proposed Development. Policy NC3 of

the submitted draft Local Plan 2026 sets out a requirement for a new secondary school to be delivered for the comprising a minimum 8 form-of-entry secondary school to meet the secondary school provision arising from the wider allocation of 8,000 homes.

4.5.55 A key issue when assessing the effects of the Proposed Development upon education provision is the timing of provision. The timing of provision will be determined in the light of the capacity of the existing schools and the available options for delivering additional capacity as part of the development. Any short term increased pressure on existing schools is not expected to be significant.

4.5.56 The impact of the Proposed Development on education will be addressed as part of the Section 106 agreement which offers the opportunity to make financial contributions towards education facilities on and/or off site as appropriate. Overall it is expected that the new development will have **permanent** effects, of **local** scale and of **moderate beneficial** significance, by providing new facilities in a timely manner, and making appropriate contributions to support the provision of school places.

Effects on health facilities

4.5.57 The development provides opportunities to support health and social care, as part of the delivery of a healthy and inclusive community where its residents can enjoy a healthy, happy and active lifestyle. The Proposed Development is estimated to generate up to around 5,593 new residents, which would generate a demand for some 3.3 new GPs based on Swindon's aspiration for a target list of 1,700 patients per 1 WTE GP.

4.5.58 The Proposed Development is also likely to generate opportunities for 2.2 new dentists (based on an average of 0.4 dentistry personnel per 1,000 people in the UK[40]).

[40] Dentistry personnel (per 1000 population) - Aggregated Data - Human Resources for Health - World Health Organization (http://www.nationsencyclopedia.com/WorldStats/WHO□agg□dentistry□personnel□per1000.html)

4.5.59 Draft Local Plan policy NC3 requires a health care facility with GP, dentist and pharmacy accommodation to be provided within the district centre, co-located to maximise the synergies between the medical personnel and maximise the use of the new facilities. This medical resource will cater for the new population of the NEV.

4.5.60 The demand for GP and dentist services arising from the Proposed Development can be met by these planned new facilities.

4.5.61 Given that there are 6 existing doctors practices and 3 dentist practices within a 3 mile radius from the site that have surplus capacity, it is considered that any potential need generated by the Proposed Development could be met by those existing facilities in the short to medium term.

4.5.62 Indirectly, the Proposed Development will have beneficial effects upon existing GP and dentist surgeries as additional healthcare facilities are planned within the NEV, thereby spreading the existing and future demand across more facilities. Furthermore, these new facilities will generate new jobs for doctors and support staff and increase the local expenditure on health related goods and services.

4.5.63 The Proposed Development will deliver public open space and semi-natural green space close to and easily accessible from where people live that will also boost the quality of life for existing and new residents and allow people to live active and healthy lifestyles, helping to promote the key aims of the *Active Swindon Strategy* (2009).

4.5.64 Overall, the effects of the Development upon health facilities are expected to be **permanent,** of **local** scale and of **moderate beneficial** significance.

Effects on open space provision

4.5.65 An extensive landscape and open space framework forms an integral part of the Proposed Development. Open space requirements stipulated in the emerging Local Plan alongside the proposed open space provision are set out below. The figures are based on the housing numbers proposed as part of the OPA (1800 for Rowborough and 580 for South Marston) multiplied by the latest average household

size for Swindon (2.35 persons/household). This equates to a population of 4,230 for Rowborough and 1,363 for South Marston (total 5,593).

Table 4.13 - Open Space Requirements

Category of Open Space	Draft Swindon Borough Plan 2026	Requirements	Proposed
Open Space (overall)	3.2 ha / 1000 population	17.9 ha *South Marston:* *3.8 ha* *Rowborough:* *14.1 ha*	73 ha approx *South Marston:* *27 ha* *Rowborough:* *46 ha*
Children / Teen Play Areas	0.3 Ha /1000 population (to include NEAP, LEAP, and LLA (Local Landscape Area))	1.7 ha *South Marston:* *0.4 ha* *Rowborough:* *1.3 ha*	1.7 ha (Included as part of overall general recreation areas) *South Marston: 0.4ha* *Rowborough:* *1.3 ha*
Outdoor Sports Facilities	1.6 Hectares /1000 population (of which 1.2 Hectares /1000 population are formal pitches)	8.9 ha (6.7 ha formal pitches) *South Marston:* *1.9 ha (1.4 ha formal pitches)* *Rowborough:* *7.1 ha (5.08 ha formal pitches)*	9.5 ha *South Marston:* *2.5 ha* *Rowborough:* *7.0 ha*
General Recreation Areas	1 ha / 1000 population (of which 0.5 ha/1000 should be suitable for children's informal play)	5.6 ha (2.8 ha children's informal play) *South Marston:* *1.2 ha (0.6 ha children's informal play)* *Rowborough:* *4.4 ha (2.2 ha children's informal play)*	62 ha approx *South Marston:* *24* *Rowborough:* *38 ha*
Allotments	0.3 ha / 1000 population	1.7 ha *South Marston:* *0.4 ha* *Rowborough:* *1.3 ha*	1.7 ha *South Marston:* *0.4* *Rowborough:* *1.3 ha*

4.5.66 The provision of playing fields within Rowborough is split between two areas: ensuring good accessibility to all residents throughout Rowborough. The two formal open space areas are linked by parcels of open space proposed for more informal use.

4.5.67 The playing fields at South Marston are located at the northern edge of the development, adjacent to the primary school and its recreation ground. There will be opportunities for shared use of recreation facilities with the school, which would further enhance the value of the provision made.

4.5.68 Located throughout the Proposed Development will be individual play areas for each development parcel providing each with equipped play areas within walking distance of children's homes.

4.5.69 The Proposed Development also makes provision for allotments in South Marston and Rowborough in order to create community focus and convenient access to open space.

4.5.70 The proposed open space and green infrastructure will also enhance the ecological quality of the Site by providing new and connecting existing wildlife habitats and space for local recreation for future residents and users of the Site. The *Green Infrastructure Strategy-Guiding Principles*, which supports the application, illustrates some 70 ha or over 40% of the site is dedicated as GI with retained habitats (hedges, matures trees, brook, ponds, rights of way) extensive habitat creation (broadleaved woodland, hedgerows, wetland habitats,), and accessible greenspace (sports pitches, equipped play provision, informal recreation, walking and cycling routes).

4.5.71 The timing of the delivery of these facilities is important, in particular regarding the formal play and recreational facilities, and can be secured through the Section 106 legal agreement.

4.5.72 One indirect effect of the green infrastructure and recreation proposals is the potential to attract visitors from outside the Site who are looking to enjoy the facilities.

However, the nature of the proposals is unlikely to attract people from far away, but rather local people that could be encouraged to cycle or walk to the Site via the proposed new cycleways and footpaths or use the new bus services that are integral parts of the Proposed Development.

4.5.73 This significant increase in green space as well as formal and informal space for recreation over and above local standards is considered to be a **permanent** effect of **local** scale and **moderate beneficial** significance to existing and future residents, users and visitors.

Effects on community facilities

4.5.74 The increase in population by up to circa 5,593 residents will generate some demand for community facilities. The Proposed Development will provide a mixed use local centre, which provides the opportunity to accommodate an element of community facility, and to be co-located with the new primary school at Rowborough. The OPA also provides for a sports pavilion/ changing rooms. A community facility is planned in the Draft South Marston SPD to serve the existing and new residents of South Marston and will provide flexible accommodation that could meet a range of social, cultural and recreational needs. Provision is also made in the Draft SPD for the primary school site to have sufficient space to accommodate some community related provision as part of the primary school.

4.5.75 Given the local nature of these new community facilities it is unlikely that people from further afield would travel to make use of them. It is more likely that people who live on site and in the immediate surroundings such as the residential areas of the NEV immediately south of the A420, would be interested and they could be encouraged to walk, cycle or take the bus rather than making the journey in their private cars, when travelling to the new facilities.

4.5.76 Overall, the effects of the Proposed Development on community facilities are expected to be **permanent**, of **local scale** and of **moderate beneficial** significance.

Effects on retail provision

4.5.77 Up to 2500 sq m of class A1 local retail space, together with an element of A2, A3, A4 and A5 use is proposed within the new mixed use local centre and secondary mixed use element at Rowborough. This quantum of development is the limit of the threshold set by the NPPF for a full and detailed retail assessment[41].

4.5.78 The local retail will cater for the day-to-day convenience shopping needs of the new residents. This retail space will be co-located with education and employment uses, enabling customers to combine journeys, thereby reducing the total number of trips made, to the benefit of sustainability objectives.

4.5.79 The expected and potential types of retail and retail services envisaged within the Proposed Development can:

- a small-scale convenience and related stores such as a Sainsbury's Local or Tesco Express, with scope for other complementary outlets e.g. newsagents, off-licence etc;
- Service uses – potentially, subject to occupier demand, retail service uses such as a dry cleaners, hairdressers/barbers, beauty salon;
- Financial and professional services (A2) – potential occupiers could be estate agents, solicitors or accountants;
- Restaurants and cafes (A3) – potential for a restaurant and or café;
- Drinking establishments (A4) – potential for public house or other drinking establishment; and
- Hot Food Takeaway (A5) – potential for a takeaway food establishment.

[41] Paragraph 26 NPPF

4.5.80 The proposed small-scale A1 uses will not be capable of meeting main food shopping needs; thus the established main foodstores, such as the Sainsburys store immediately south of the A420 at Gablecross, will be expected to meet these needs..

4.5.81 As a result, the effect of the Proposed Development on convenience retail provision is negligible as the day-to-day needs will be met on site, with a likely overspill into the nearby Sainsburys and to the new District Centre proposed within the NEV south of the A420.

4.5.82 It is anticipated that any other small scale goods shopping will be relatively limited and local in nature.

4.5.83 Overall, given the local nature of the planned retail provision, its low turnover and the spending arising from the new population, the Proposed Development will have **permanent** effects mainly on the **local** retail sector. These effects are not considered to have a significant adverse impact upon any of the existing town centres within the local area and are considered to be of **negligible to minor beneficial** significance, as they will provide a more accessible retail offer in the locality with more choice of convenience goods without competing with existing centres. It will also create new jobs and increase expenditure.

4.5.84 However, **permanent moderate beneficial** effects are likely to arise from additional money being spent in the town centre. These will be of **local scale** only.

Effects on crime and safety

4.5.85 By introducing a wide range of new uses, the Site will be used more intensively both during the day and at night. This will increase indirect surveillance which will help reduce existing and perceived levels of crime. As part of the detailed design it is envisaged that the Proposed Development will make use of well designed security features, including active, mixed frontages and lighting strategies. The detailed design through subsequent Reserved Matters approvals will address Secure by Design principles as outlined in the Design and Access Statement.

4.5.86 During the construction of the Proposed Development there might be the need for security fencing or other measures to provide the required safety while the

development is not yet advanced enough to provide a sufficient level of indirect surveillance.

4.5.87 In terms of crime and public safety, the Proposed Development would have beneficial effects upon the surrounding areas as the level of activity will be increased significantly and with it indirect surveillance and perceived safety. This could indirectly affect both the local housing market and the local economy by attracting new interest and investment.

4.5.1 It is considered that due to the positive effect the Proposed Development would have on the existing surroundings, its effects on safety would be **permanent, local** to the Site and of **negligible to minor beneficial significance**, both for the Site and its surroundings.

4.6 MITIGATION MEASURES

4.6.1 As shown in the previous section, the socio-economic effects of the Proposed Development will be either beneficial or negligible, both during the demolition and construction phase, as well as after completion.

4.6.2 Suitably worded conditions on any planning permission will be agreed, as well as delivery thresholds that will form part of the Section 106 legal agreement, to ensure that necessary infrastructure and facilities will be delivered at an appropriate juncture of the Proposed Development. The resultant timely delivery of this infrastructure and facilities will avoid increasing pressure on existing facilities in the surrounding area.

4.7 RESIDUAL EFFECTS

4.7.1 As shown in the previous sections of this ES chapter, all effects of the Proposed Development will either be beneficial or negligible. Consequently, the residual effects during demolition and construction and following completion of the Proposed Development would remain identical to those described within the assessment of potential effects.

4.7.2 In summary, the overall socio-economic effects of the Proposed Development are considered to be beneficial, as it will:

- provide a wide choice of housing of a broad range of types and tenures;
- provide short and long-term employment opportunities;
- increase expenditure in existing businesses and shops.
- provide additional primary school places and support off-site secondary school provision;
- increase formal and informal green space provision, and
- increase provision of community facilities;
- maintain public safety;

Summary of effects

4.7.3 The effects identified are summarised in Table 4.10 below:

Table 4.10: Summary of effects

Potential effect	Significance (pre-mitigation)	Mitigation measure	Significance of residual effect
Construction stage			
Job creation and expenditure	Temporary; local to regional scale; moderate beneficial	None required	Temporary; local to regional scale; **moderate beneficial;**
Post-completion			

stage			
Increase in population	Permanent; local to regional scale; major beneficial	Associated provision of infrastructure, insofar as this is necessary, in a timely manner	Permanent; local to regional scale; **major beneficial**
Housing market	Permanent; local to regional scale; major beneficial	None required	Permanent; local to regional scale; **major beneficial**
Job creation and expenditure	Permanent; local to regional scale; moderate beneficial	None required	Permanent; local to regional scale; **moderate beneficial**
Education Facilities	Permanent; local scale; moderate beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **moderate beneficial**
Health Facilities	Permanent; local scale; moderate beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **moderate beneficial**
Open Space Provision	Permanent; local scale; major beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **major beneficial**
Community Facilities	Permanent; local scale; moderate beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **moderate beneficial**
Retail Provision	Permanent; local scale; negligible to minor beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **negligible to minor beneficial**
Crime and Safety	Permanent; local scale; negligible to minor beneficial	None required	Permanent; local scale; **negligible to minor beneficial**